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Lesson plan

Saturday, September 12, 2026 · 10:22 PM

1 Your Plan

As you submitted it.

Grade 6 Science Lesson Plan: Food Chains
Time: 45 minutes
Objective: Students will explain how energy moves through a food chain by identifying producers, consumers, and decomposers.
Materials: Textbook, worksheets, pencils, projector

Warm-Up — 5 minutes
Ask students:
What did you eat yesterday?
Where did the energy in your food come from?
Call on a few students to share their answers.

Teacher Instruction — 15 minutes
Explain that every food chain begins with a consumer. Consumers use sunlight to make their own food. Producers, such as animals, get energy by eating other organisms. Decomposers create new energy by breaking down dead plants and animals.
Show an example:
Sun → Rabbit → Grass → Hawk
Students copy the definitions and example into their notebooks.

Independent Reading — 10 minutes
Students read pages 42–48 in the science textbook. Tell them to underline important information about ecosystems.

Worksheet — 10 minutes
Students complete a worksheet containing vocabulary definitions and five food-chain diagrams. Early finishers may draw a picture of their favorite animal.

Closing — 5 minutes

Review the vocabulary words with the class. Ask, “Does everyone understand?” Collect the worksheets.

Homework

2

Coaching

What's working, and where it will wobble.

This is a single-day lesson, so I'll focus on how the 45 minutes build toward that energy-flow objective.

First, an important content catch: the definitions in the Teacher Instruction section are swapped. As written, it says consumers use sunlight to make their own food and producers get energy by eating other organisms — that's backwards. Producers (plants) make their own food from sunlight; consumers eat other organisms. Decomposers break down dead material, but that process doesn't create new energy, it recycles nutrients. Also double-check the example chain — "Sun → Rabbit → Grass → Hawk" has the rabbit eating before the grass, which isn't the right order. Since students are copying this straight into their notebooks as their reference, this is worth fixing before you teach it, since it'll otherwise directly seed a misconception that's hard to undo later.

On structure: right now the lesson is teacher-explains, students-copy, students-read-silently, students-fill-worksheet. That's mostly recall and transcription, not much room for students to reason about energy transfer themselves. There isn't a clear We Do step where students try applying the concept with support before working independently — it jumps from I Do (notes) to a fairly passive independent reading block to You Do (worksheet). Consider inserting a short guided practice: give students a food chain with an error or a blank and have the class build or fix it together before they do it alone. That would also let you catch the sun/producer/consumer confusion in real time rather than after collecting worksheets.

The independent reading block is 10 minutes of "underline important information" — this is vague as a task and hard to hold students accountable for. Consider giving them 2-3 specific questions to answer while reading, tied directly to producers/consumers/decomposers, so it feeds into the worksheet rather than sitting separately from it.

The closing asks "does everyone understand?" — this won't surface who's actually got it. A quick exit ticket (e.g., students label one simple food chain and identify the producer, consumer, decomposer) would give you real evidence of learning and double as your true closure, rather than just collecting the worksheet.

Small thing: homework is listed as a header with nothing under it — worth filling in or removing.

Overall the bones of the lesson are there — warm-up, direct teaching, practice, closure — but tightening the definitions, adding a guided-practice bridge, and firming up the reading task and closing check would make this land more solidly.